



RESOURCE LIBRARY · VOLUME 2

Invisible Grief Worksheets

The grief nobody sees — the losses that don't come with funerals, flowers, or condolence cards. This workbook helps you name it, feel it, and begin to carry it differently.

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HEALING BEYOND DIAGNOSIS INITIATIVE

"Recovery is not returning to who you were.
Recovery is learning who you are now."

— Beyond Diagnosis Theory™



What Is Invisible Grief?

The grief that doesn't get a funeral

Invisible grief is the grief that comes without death — but carries the same weight. It's the loss of who you were. The loss of the life you planned. The loss of abilities, independence, relationships, career, or identity. It's real. It's heavy. And most people never get the chance to name it, because the world doesn't recognize it as grief.

Types of Invisible Grief

Invisible grief comes in many forms. Check the ones you've experienced:

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Identity grief — losing who you thought you were | ☐ Social grief — losing friendships and community connection |
| ☐ Ambiguous grief — grieving someone still alive (or a life that still exists but feels unreachable) | ☐ Vocational grief — losing your career or professional identity |
| ☐ Anticipatory grief — grieving what you know is coming | ☐ Autonomy grief — losing independence and control |
| ☐ Functional grief — grieving lost abilities (cognitive, physical, emotional) | ☐ Future grief — grieving the plans and dreams that no longer fit |
| ☐ Role grief — losing your role as provider, protector, parent, partner | ☐ Caregiver grief — grieving the person your loved one was before |

REFLECTION

Which type of invisible grief hits hardest for you right now? Why?



Naming Your Invisible Losses

You can't process grief you haven't named

Many people carry invisible grief for years without ever putting it into words. This exercise asks you to be specific about what you've lost — not to dwell in pain, but to acknowledge it. Naming it is the first step to carrying it differently.

LOSS 1

What is something you lost that nobody talks about?

LOSS 2

What ability, routine, or part of daily life do you miss most?

LOSS 3

What relationship or connection has changed because of your injury/diagnosis?

LOSS 4

What dream or plan for your future feels out of reach now?

LOSS 5

What part of yourself do you grieve the most?

You just did something brave. Naming grief is not weakness — it's the beginning of not carrying it alone.



The Weight You Carry

Making the invisible visible

If you could weigh your grief — if it were something you could hold — how heavy would each piece be? Rate each area from 1 (barely noticeable) to 10 (crushing weight).

TYPE OF LOSS	WEIGHT (1-10)	ONE SENTENCE ABOUT THIS LOSS
Loss of identity		
Loss of independence		
Loss of relationships		
Loss of career / purpose		
Loss of future plans		
Loss of cognitive abilities		
Loss of physical abilities		
Loss of emotional stability		
Loss of confidence		
Loss of being understood		

REFLECTION

Looking at your heaviest weights — who knows about these losses? Have you ever told anyone?

What would it feel like to share even one of these with someone you trust?



Permission to Grieve

You are allowed to grieve — even if nobody told you so

One of the cruelest parts of invisible grief is that nobody gives you permission to feel it. There's no ritual, no ceremony, no time off work. The world keeps moving. And you're expected to keep up. This page is your permission slip.

Things I Need Permission to Grieve

Write the things you've been carrying but haven't allowed yourself to fully feel. Start each one with "I am allowed to grieve..."

I am allowed to grieve...

I am allowed to grieve...

I am allowed to grieve...

I am allowed to grieve...

Things I Need to Hear

Check the statements you need to believe — even if you're not there yet:

☐

My grief is valid even if nobody else sees it

- ☐ I don't need to compare my losses to someone else's
- ☐ Crying doesn't mean I'm not strong
- ☐ Being angry is part of grief — it's allowed
- ☐ I don't have to "get over it" on anyone's timeline
- ☐ Grief and hope can exist at the same time



Processing Invisible Grief

A step-by-step guide to working through what you're carrying

You don't process grief all at once. You don't process it in order. But having a framework helps you move through it intentionally instead of being swept away by it.

1 Name It

What specific loss are you carrying today? Write it in one sentence.

2 Feel It

Where does this grief live in your body? (chest, stomach, throat, shoulders?) What does it feel like?

3 Honor It

What did this loss mean to you? Why did it matter?

4 Express It

How can you let this grief out today? (writing, talking, crying, creating, moving)

5 Carry It Differently

You may not be able to put it down — but can you carry it differently? What would that look like?



Building Your Grief Support Network

Grief was never meant to be carried alone

Invisible grief isolates. When nobody sees your loss, you stop trying to explain it. But healing requires connection — even if it's just one person who gets it.

My Support Network

INNER CIRCLE

People who truly understand what you're going through (or are willing to try)

SUPPORT CIRCLE

People who care about you, even if they don't fully understand

PROFESSIONAL SUPPORT

Counsellors, coaches, therapists, support groups, helplines

COMMUNITY

Online groups, peer support, organizations, faith communities

WHAT I NEED MOST RIGHT NOW

Check what would help most:

- ☐ Someone to listen without trying to fix it
- ☐ Practical help (meals, rides, appointments)
- ☐ Professional guidance (counselling, coaching)
- ☐ Connection with others who understand
- ☐ Time and space to process
- ☐ Permission to not be okay for a while

"When rehabilitation ends, emotional recovery is often just beginning."

— Healing Beyond Diagnosis Initiative